

456 Bridge Road,
Cobblebank Victoria, 3338

Student Code of Conduct Policy

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to set out the conduct expected of students at Rosewood College.

Rosewood College (the College) is an independent school teaching the Catholic faith. The College seeks to form students in faith, virtue, responsibility and respect, and to provide a safe, orderly and caring learning environment where each student is known, valued and supported to grow.

This policy supports student safety, wellbeing, learning, behaviour formation, child safety, duty of care, respectful relationships, anti-bullying practice and the College's commitment to Australian democratic principles.

This policy recognises that Rosewood College students are primary-aged students from Foundation to Year 5. Student expectations are therefore taught, modelled, practised and reinforced in an age-appropriate way, with staff support and parent partnership.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all students of Rosewood College.

It applies whenever a student is participating in, representing or identifiable as connected with the College, including:

- during the school day
- before and after school while under College supervision
- during class, break times, assemblies, liturgies, Mass, formation activities and College events
- during excursions, sport, performances and offsite activities, including camps where approved by the College
- during online learning or digital communication connected with the College
- while travelling to or from school where behaviour affects the safety, wellbeing or reputation of the College community
- during interactions with students, staff, parents, volunteers, contractors, visitors and members of the wider community

3. Policy

3.1 Student conduct principles

Students are expected to conduct themselves in a manner consistent with the College's Catholic identity, philosophy, values and commitment to the dignity of every person.

Students are expected to:

- act with respect, honesty and kindness
- listen to staff and follow reasonable staff directions
- try their best in learning and College activities
- use safe hands, safe feet and respectful words
- care for younger students and be a good example to others
- treat others fairly and include others where possible
- respect the property, privacy and personal space of others
- wear the College uniform correctly and with care
- use technology only as allowed by staff
- ask a staff member for help when they feel worried, unsafe, hurt, confused or unsure what to do

Students are learning how to make good choices. Staff support students to understand expectations, practise respectful behaviour, repair harm where appropriate and seek help when they need it.

3.2 Respect for others

Students must treat every person with dignity and respect.

Students are expected to:

- speak kindly and truthfully
- listen when others are speaking
- take turns and share fairly
- keep hands, feet and objects to themselves
- respect differences between people
- include others and avoid leaving people out on purpose
- say sorry and repair harm where appropriate
- tell a staff member if someone is being hurt, bullied, excluded or treated unfairly

Students must not:

- bully, tease, threaten, intimidate or humiliate others
- use words, gestures, drawings, images or actions that are rude, cruel, racist, sexist, discriminatory or degrading
- hurt another person physically
- damage another person's belongings

- spread rumours or private information
- encourage others to do the wrong thing
- pressure another student to keep unsafe behaviour secret
- respond to conflict with aggression or revenge

3.3 Safety and child safety

Students must act in ways that support their own safety and the safety of others.

Students are expected to:

- tell a staff member if they or another student feel unsafe
- report bullying, harassment, unsafe behaviour or child safety concerns
- follow staff instructions during supervision, first aid, emergencies and offsite activities
- stay in approved student areas
- use equipment, furniture, resources and facilities safely
- avoid bringing unsafe, prohibited or inappropriate items to school
- seek adult help rather than trying to manage serious problems alone

Students must not:

- leave the College boundary without permission and authorised collection
- hide from staff supervision
- climb on fences, gates, buildings, roofs, ramps, stairs, furniture or equipment not intended for climbing
- interfere with emergency equipment, first aid equipment, gates, locks, signs or safety controls
- touch hazardous materials, cleaning products, maintenance equipment, tools or contractor equipment
- enter staff-only areas, service areas, utility areas, contractor areas or restricted areas unless authorised and supervised

Child safety concerns must always be treated as safety matters first. Behaviour that may involve child abuse, grooming, sexual misconduct, reportable conduct, mandatory reporting, criminal conduct or serious risk must be escalated under the College's child safety and incident management procedures.

3.4 Movement, buildings and play areas

Students are expected to move safely and calmly around the College.

Students must:

- stay in areas approved for student use
- move between the Classroom Building, Administration Building, Covered Deck, Toilet Building, Covered Play Area and Playground and Open Play Area as directed by staff
- walk on decks, ramps, stairs, paths and indoor areas
- stay with their class or group unless a staff member gives permission to leave

- ask a staff member before going to Reception, the First Aid Room, the Chapel / Multi-Purpose Space or the Interview Room
- keep away from the Northern Service Yard, Southern Service Yard, utility areas, plant areas, contractor areas, storage areas, staff areas and unattended buildings unless a staff member gives permission and supervises the access
- tell a staff member if a gate, fence, path, ramp, stair, toilet area, playground area or building area looks unsafe

Students must not:

- enter restricted or no-play areas
- cross service or emergency access areas unless supervised by staff
- remain in an activity space after the responsible staff member has left
- run indoors, on decks, on ramps, on stairs or in transition areas
- play in areas that staff have closed, restricted or identified as unsafe
- interfere with deliveries, maintenance, service access or emergency access

3.5 Toilets and privacy

Students must use the Toilet Building safely, respectfully and only for its proper purpose.

Students are expected to:

- go to the Toilet Building with staff permission or in accordance with class routines
- return promptly to the supervised area
- respect the privacy of others
- use quiet and appropriate behaviour
- wash hands before returning to learning or play
- tell a staff member if they feel unsafe
- tell a staff member if another person does not respect privacy in or near the Toilet Building
- tell a staff member if another student is unwell, upset, hurt or unsafe
- tell a staff member if the toilets need cleaning or maintenance

Students must not:

- play, hide, climb, damage property or waste supplies in or near the Toilet Building
- look into private spaces
- block doors or prevent another student from leaving
- tease, frighten, shame or exclude others
- use the Toilet Building as a place to avoid class, supervision or staff directions
- enter a toilet area not allocated for their use unless a staff member has authorised an individual arrangement

3.6 Learning and participation

Students are expected to:

- attend school and classes punctually
- come prepared for learning
- listen respectfully to teachers and other students
- allow others to learn without disruption
- try their best and complete learning tasks
- participate in prayer, formation, assemblies, liturgies, Mass where celebrated, and College activities with respect
- accept feedback and correction respectfully
- ask for help when learning, wellbeing or behaviour difficulties arise

Students are not expected to solve every difficulty on their own. Students should ask a staff member for help when they do not understand work, feel upset, experience conflict or are unsure what choice to make.

3.7 Property and the College environment

Students are expected to:

- care for College property, resources, books, technology, equipment and facilities
- respect the belongings of others
- keep classrooms, outdoor areas, toilets and shared spaces clean and orderly
- put rubbish in bins
- use furniture and equipment for their intended purpose
- report damage, hazards or unsafe conditions to staff
- avoid vandalism, theft, misuse or waste of property

3.8 Technology and online conduct

Students must use technology in accordance with the College's Internet and Technology Use Policy and staff instructions.

Students must:

- use devices only when allowed by staff
- use College systems and accounts appropriately
- keep passwords and login details private
- be kind and respectful in online communication
- tell a staff member if they see unsafe, upsetting or inappropriate online content
- tell a staff member if technology is being used to hurt, embarrass, threaten or exclude someone

Students must not:

- use technology to bully, harass, threaten, shame or exclude others
- record, photograph or share images of others without permission
- access, create or share inappropriate, harmful or unsafe content

- pretend to be another person online
- misuse passwords, accounts or systems
- interfere with College systems or digital learning environments
- use personal devices contrary to College expectations

3.9 Conduct outside the classroom

Students are expected to uphold this policy during:

- recess and lunch
- arrival and dismissal
- transitions between learning areas
- assemblies, prayer, liturgies and Mass
- visits to Reception or the First Aid Room
- use of the Toilet Building
- wet-weather arrangements
- excursions, camps and offsite activities
- sport, performances and community events
- online interactions connected with the College

3.10 Response to student conduct concerns

The College responds to student conduct concerns in a manner that is:

- child-safe
- age-appropriate
- fair and consistent
- educative and restorative where appropriate
- proportionate to the seriousness and context of the behaviour
- attentive to disability, vulnerability, trauma, health, wellbeing and developmental factors
- consistent with duty of care, supervision and behaviour management obligations

Possible responses may include:

- reminder or redirection
- re-teaching the expected behaviour
- moving a student to a safer or more suitable place
- restorative conversation
- apology or repair of harm where appropriate
- loss of access to an activity or area for a period of time
- parent or guardian contact
- mentoring or wellbeing support

- behaviour support strategies
- adjustment to supervision or participation arrangements
- recording in behaviour or incident records
- formal behaviour management action
- suspension or expulsion only in accordance with the Suspension and Expulsion Procedure

Corporal punishment is prohibited.

4. Implementation

The Principal is responsible for implementing this policy.

Staff are responsible for:

- modelling respectful, safe and child-safe conduct
- teaching student expectations in age-appropriate language
- using routines, reminders, visual supports and explicit instruction where helpful
- supervising students actively in accordance with College supervision arrangements
- reinforcing safe movement, toilet, playground, classroom and technology expectations
- responding to conduct concerns promptly
- recording behaviour, safety or wellbeing concerns as required
- escalating serious concerns in accordance with College procedures
- applying behaviour responses fairly and consistently

Students are responsible for:

- learning and following this policy at an age-appropriate level
- asking for help when needed
- listening to staff direction and correction
- helping to keep the College safe and welcoming
- repairing harm where appropriate

Parents and guardians support implementation by:

- reinforcing College expectations at home
- encouraging students to seek staff help when needed
- working respectfully with staff
- supporting behaviour, wellbeing or learning plans where required
- raising concerns through appropriate College channels

The College communicates student expectations through age-appropriate classroom routines, staff direction, parent communication, the Parent Handbook, induction processes and related policies and procedures.

Records relating to student conduct are managed in accordance with the College's behaviour, incident, complaints, privacy and records management procedures.

5. Review

This policy will be reviewed at least every two years, or earlier if required due to:

- a serious student conduct, child safety or wellbeing incident
- changes to legislation, Ministerial Orders, VRQA guidance or registration expectations
- changes to the College's buildings, student access boundaries, supervision model, student cohort or operational arrangements
- changes to related College policies or procedures
- feedback from staff, students, parents or guardians
- a governance or operational review identifying that the policy is unclear, incomplete or ineffective

The Principal is responsible for coordinating review.

Material amendments must be approved by the Governing Authority.

6. Related Documents

Related documents include:

- Anti-Bullying and Harassment Policy
- Child Safety Code of Conduct Policy
- Internet and Technology Use Policy
- Student Behaviour Management Policy
- Uniform Policy

7. Appendix A: Site Supervision Map

